THE FUTURE OF MONEY 2025

Economic uncertainty continues to shape how Americans earn, save and make financial decisions. Despite ongoing pessimism about the broader economy, people remain resilient and are adapting their financial behavior to manage rising costs and future uncertainty. This edition of the Logica® Future of Money highlight report explores how Americans are adjusting their spending, building emergency savings, evaluating job stability and navigating new expectations around work.

This wave of the study also captures a shift in the workplace. AI adoption has accelerated rapidly, and while many workers feel optimistic about how AI can improve their jobs, others worry about task replacement or full job disruption. These shifts, along with rising commuting costs and uneven job security, are pushing many workers to look for greater stability and support.

Americans continue to prioritize saving while seeking help with investing and maintaining interest in a mix of traditional and emerging investment products. The insights from our latest study offer financial organizations and employers a roadmap for developing tools, resources and communications that meet people's needs during a period of uncertainty.

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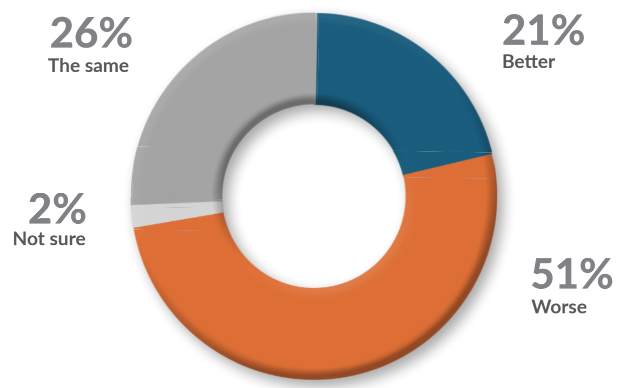
SAVING MORE AND CUTTING SPENDING THROUGH UNCERTAINTY

Americans remain cautious about the economy. About half (51%) say economic conditions are worse than one year ago, while only about one in five (21%) believe things have improved. Expectations for the coming year remain split, reflecting continued unease.

About half of Americans say the economy is worse today than it was a year ago



More than a third of Americans (36%) say they are spending less because of economic conditions. At the same time, people are taking steps to protect themselves. Thirty-six percent (36%) say they are saving more or saving specifically for emergencies, and Americans now have an average of five months of emergency savings.

Americans with 3+ months of emergency savings report lower stress than those with limited reserves, demonstrating how short-term financial buffers help people feel more secure.

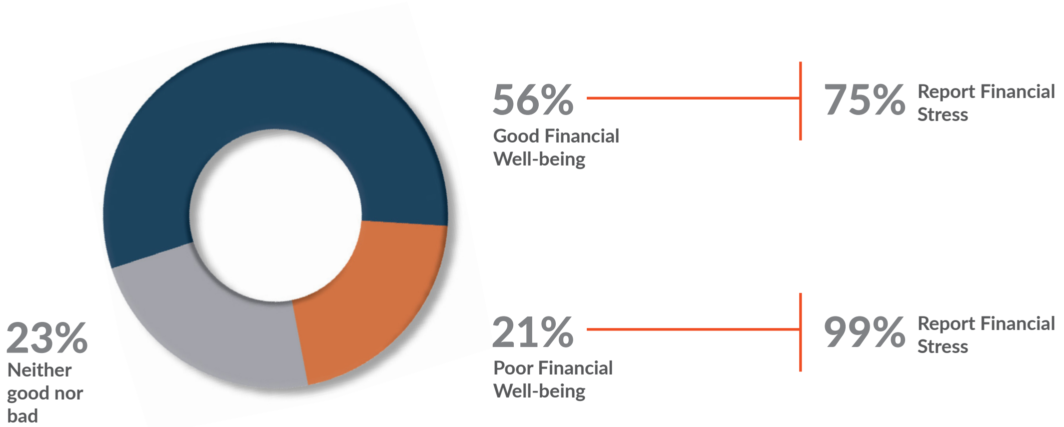
Tip for financial institutions and advisors:

Financial institutions can provide value by supporting households looking to build or rebuild emergency savings, offering budgeting tools and stabilizing products that help people manage financial uncertainty.

FINANCIAL WELL-BEING AND STRESS FOR AMERICANS

Financial well-being varies widely among Americans. In this wave of the Logica® Future of Money Study, 56% say their financial well-being is somewhat or very good, but stress remains high: 75% of this group still experiences financial stress and still want help for investing and everyday money management.

Those who report poor financial well-being (21%) face much heavier pressure. Nearly all (99%) say they feel stressed frequently. This group has strong needs around investing basics (65%), managing money during uncertain economic times (64%) and managing debt (63%).



Americans with good financial well-being report an average household income of $117,000 per year, nearly twice the $64,000 reported by those with poor financial well-being.

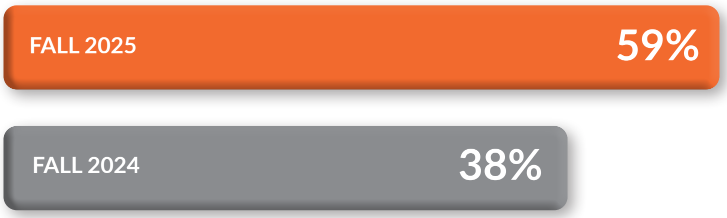
Tip for financial institutions and advisors:

Financial companies can support people by offering practical education, investing guidance and tools for everyday decisions. Tailoring solutions by financial well-being segment can strengthen trust and impact.

HOW JOB SECURITY AND WORK COSTS ARE SHAPING DECISIONS

Job stability and work-related costs are becoming more influential in Americans' financial mindset. Compared with last year, a larger share of employed Americans say they are somewhat or very likely to switch employers in the next 12 months (52% in Fall 2025 vs. 40% in Fall 2024). Those likely to switch employers feel less secure in their job (38%) when compared to those not likely to switch (59%).

Americans are more likely to switch employers when they feel less secure in their job, compared to last year.



With both job security and daily costs top of mind, employees are paying close attention to the benefits their employers provide. Eighty-three percent (83%) of workers say it is important for employers to offer financial programs that support money management, a consistent and strong signal across all generations.

Commuting now costs workers an average of $20 a day, but those likely to switch employers spend $26, nearly double the $14 spent by workers planning to stay, a gap that may influence job decisions.

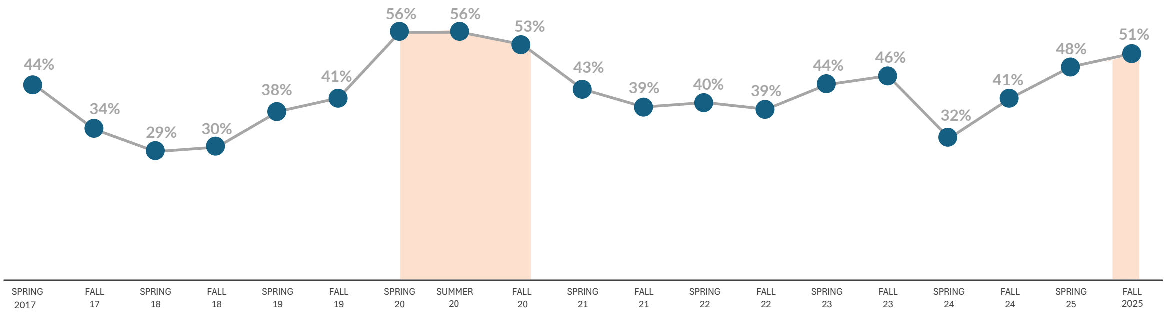
Tip for financial institutions and advisors:

Employers focused on retention can address the full financial picture by supporting commuting costs or work from home options, offering financial wellness programs and giving employees access to financial guidance options.

AI'S GROWING USAGE IN THE WORKPLACE

Technology's influence on work is rising fast. Fifty-one percent (51%) of Americans say it will have the greatest impact on their work in the next five years, up from 41% one year ago. Levels are nearly up to what was reported during the pandemic in 2020.

Americans' view of technology's impact on work 2017-2025



Fifty-six percent (56%) of workers say their employer uses AI and are more likely to use publicly available tools. Adoption is more common among full-time employees than part-time, and workers with higher incomes report greater familiarity with AI tools.

Desk-based employees are far more likely to use AI at work, with 68% using it compared with 41% of non-desk-based workers, signaling the potential for increasing gaps in tech adoption by job type.

Tip for financial institutions and advisors:

To support responsible and confident AI use, organizations can offer structured training, real-world examples and clear expectations about how employees should incorporate AI into their work.

WORKER SENTIMENT ON AI: OPTIMISM AND UNCERTAINTY

As AI becomes part of the workday, Americans hold mixed views. Many believe it will improve their job performance and say they want more training to strengthen their AI skills. Employers are providing support to help workers use AI, including online resources and company-wide discussions. Employees who rely on publicly available AI tools are especially likely to use online resources, with 48% favoring them compared with 37% of those using proprietary tools.

Top employer-provided AI resources used by employees

- **44%** Online resources
- **42%** Company-wide meeting or discussion
- **32%** Policies or restrictions on the use of AI
- **30%** Independent courses or certifications

Workers who fear full job replacement (24%) are significantly more likely to be in non-desk-based roles, emphasizing the uneven distribution of AI benefits and concerns.

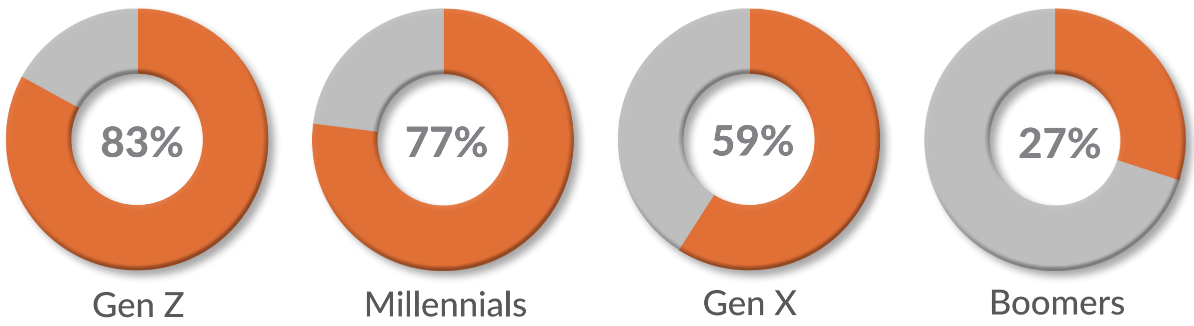
Tip for financial institutions and advisors:

Employers can support workers by offering clear AI resources, such as online training and company-wide discussions. Providing options that fit different job types and comfort levels can help people feel more confident using AI at work.

PAYMENT BEHAVIORS REMAIN STEADY AS TRUST DRIVES CHOICE

Payment habits have remained steady in this wave of the Logica® Future of Money Study. Credit cards continue to be the preferred method for online shopping, while debit cards lead for in-person purchases. Mobile payments are firmly mainstream, with more than half of Americans (57%) using their phone to pay in stores, driven largely by younger generations.

Generational usage of phone/mobile device for in-person purchases



Online, most people prefer credit or debit cards because they trust these payment methods. Buy Now Pay Later usage shows mixed movement, and awareness and use of digital payment apps remain steady.

Younger Gen Z (16–22) uses cash for in-person purchases more often than older Gen Z, 35% compared with 21%. Older Gen Z (23–28) is more likely to use debit cards, 38% compared with 25%.

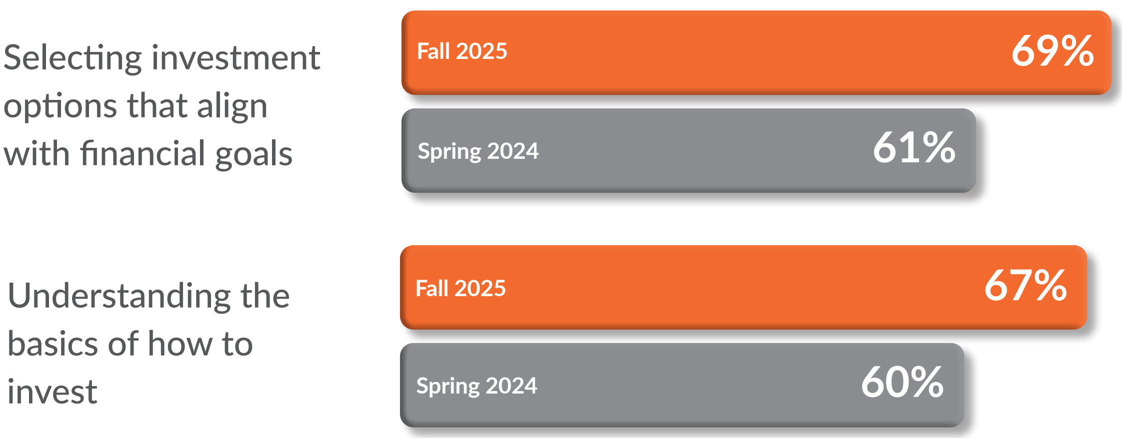
Tip for financial institutions and advisors:

Payment and fintech providers can build stronger engagement by focusing on trust, ease of use and security features, particularly for online payments where confidence drives choice.

INVESTING AND MONEY MANAGEMENT SHOWING STEADY ENGAGEMENT

Americans continue to seek guidance on investing, as shown persistently throughout the waves of the Logica® Future of Money Study. Sixty-one percent (61%) say they need help choosing investment options, understanding the basics and knowing when to buy or sell. Gen X shows the strongest demand, reflecting the decisions they face as they balance mid-career responsibilities, college payments and retirement planning.

Gen X interest in financial advice rising over the past six months



More than half of Gen X are investors (52%), and they are likely to own traditional products like individual stocks (30%), mutual funds (23%) and money market funds (20%).

Tip for financial institutions and advisors:

Providing simple, actionable investing guidance tailored to Gen Xers (largely in their fifties) impacted by increased income demands, children's college costs, elder care and retirement preparation can meet a growing need for clarity and confidence.

CONCLUSION

This wave of the Logica Future of Money Study shows Americans adapting to uncertainty with a mix of caution and resilience. People are cutting back on spending, building emergency savings, reassessing job stability and adjusting to new expectations around AI in the workplace. Even those who feel financially stable continue to experience stress, and many want clearer guidance for everyday decisions such as budgeting, debt management, investing and long-term planning.

These findings highlight a strong opportunity for financial companies and advisors. Consumers are looking for trusted partners who can help them manage volatility, understand new financial tools, make confident investing choices and navigate the pressures of work and family life. Organizations that focus on transparency, simple guidance and solutions tailored to real-world financial pressures will be well positioned to support people through ongoing shifts in the economy and workplace and to build lasting relationships in the process.

ABOUT THE STUDY

The Logica® Future of Money Study is a twice-yearly research report that offers a detailed 360-degree snapshot of the current consumer money mindset. The online study has been running since 2017 and is conducted among 1,000 U.S. adults and an augment of 200 older Gen Zers (16-27 years old). This wave was conducted in October 2025. The insights in the ongoing Logica Future of Money Study are geared toward helping financial brands and institutions develop strategies, products and communications to improve people's financial lives. The new Logica Future of Money report covers specifics about how people are making, spending, managing their money, and engaging with financial brands.

ABOUT LOGICA RESEARCH

Logica Research creates custom marketing research solutions to help companies build the products and services that improve people's financial lives and drive business growth. The Future of Money Study is designed to give companies insights into how people think about money. Those insights can be used to help drive product innovation and create engaging communications that will wow customers. Insights from the research that Logica has conducted for clients have been published in the largest media outlets in the world including the *New York Times*, *The Financial Times*, *The Wall Street Journal*, CNN, *Newsweek*, *Time*, and *USA Today*. www.logicaresearch.com